ESCOLA SECUNDÁRIA

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ECO-CITIZENS FOR A SUSTAINABLE EUROPE

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FUNCHAL, MADEIRA - 27.04.2026 - 01.05.2026

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DATE	TIME	ACTIVITY
26/04 SUN	16:05	Arrival of the Polish delegation
		Arrival of the Greek delegation
27/04 MON	10:00	Meeting point – school's main entrance
	10:10	- Welcome by the school's headmistress - Visiting the host school - Welcoming ceremony
	13:00	Lunch for teachers
	15:00	Treasure Hunt at the Municipal Garden (outdoor education – learning about endemic species)
	16:00	Outdoor ioga session (Eco-movement)
	17:00	End of the day's activities
28/04 TUE	08:45	Meeting point – cable car building
	09:00	Visiting the eastern part of the Island - Machico, Caniçal (Wale Museum), Ponta de São Lourenço, Faial (sightseeing point), Santana, Achadas do Teixeira (eco-hike to see the peaks (*Areeiro and Ruivo*) - Lunch – picnic in Santana (Wale Museum: 2€ per person) (Bus - 20€ per person)
	17:00	Return to Funchal – end of the day's activities
29/04 WED	08:45	Meeting point – cable car building
	09:00	Visiting the northern part of the Island - São Vicente, Seixal (sightseeing point – *Véu da Noiva*), Chão da Ribeira, Porto Moniz, Fanal, Encumeada - Eco-hike (*Poço do Candeeiro*) - Lunch – picnic (*Espetada*) at a typical cottage (10€ per person) (Bus - 20€ per person)
	17:00	Return to Funchal – end of the day's activities
30/04 THU	08:45	Meeting point – cable car building

	09:00	Visiting the western part of the Island - Cabo Girão, Ponta do Sol, Lugar de Baixo (visit to the Banana Museum), visiting a banana plantation and learning about its production (outdoor education) - *Levada* hike (Eco-movement) - Lunch – picnic at the banana plantation (Banana Museum: 2€ per person) (Bus - 20€ per person)
	18:00	Return to Funchal – end of the day's activities

01/05 FRI	08:45	Meeting point – Funchal marina
	09:00	eTwinning activity
	10:30	- Catamaran trip – learning about marine conservation - Certificates (catamaran – 25€ per person)
	13:30	End of the day's activities for students
		Project evaluation meeting (teachers)
	14:30	Farewell lunch (teachers)
	19:45	Departure of the Polish delegation

02/05 SAT	09:40	Departure of the Greek delegation

MADEIRA

- The archipelago of Madeira has 2 inhabited islands, Madeira and Porto Santo, and 2 groups of uninhabited islands, Desertas and Selvagens, both of which are natural preserves.
- The archipelago is an autonomous region, with its own regional president, government and parliament, so it has political and administrative autonomy.
- Geomorphologically, Porto Santo is 8 million years old and Madeira 5 million years old.
- There are some literary references to the two islands, back then called the "Isles of the Blessed", which date back to the military commander Quintus Sertorius (126-73 BC). There is also archaeological evidence that suggests that the islands were visited by the Vikings between 900 and 1030 AC. The islands were shown on maps as early as 1339.
- Madeira was rediscovered in 1419, by captains Tristão Vaz Teixeira, João Gonçalves Zarco and Bartolomeu Perestrelo.
- The first settlers were the families of the three captains, members of the gentry and former inmates. The majority of the following settlers were fishermen and farmers, looking to escape the Black Death that had

ravaged Portugal and trying to find good farmlands that weren't controlled by the nobility, as in continental Portugal.

- *Madeira* = Portuguese word for *wood* (the island was uninhabited at the time of discovery and covered in trees, hence the name).
- The archipelago has 801km2 and 251.060 inhabitants (in 2021), half of which lives in or around Funchal, the capital city, that dates back to 1508.
- It is located 970km from Lisbon, 700km from the African Coast and 450km from the Canary Islands and at the same latitude as Casablanca, Morocco.
- It has a GDP (Gross Domestic Product) of 2.4%, after Lisbon (36%), the north of Portugal (29.7%), the centre of Portugal (18.8%), Alentejo (6.3%) and Algarve with 4.8%. The Azores detain 2.1% of the GDP.
- Portugal has the 5th largest exclusive economic zone (EEZ) within Europe, 3rd largest of the EU and the 20th largest EEZ in the world, because of the two archipelagos, Madeira and the Azores. (**E**xclusive **E**conomic **Z**one is an area of the sea in which a sovereign state has special rights regarding the exploration and use of marine resources, including energy production from water and wind)
- Currently, the great engine of the Madeira's economy is tourism, as Madeira is one of the most attractive destinations in Europe. In agriculture, banana production (mainly directed at regional and national consumption), flowers and the famous Madeira wine also make an important contribution to the regional economy.
- Industrial activity in the Madeira Autonomous Region has become increasingly diverse, highlighting small industries oriented to local consumption (pasta, dairy products, production and packaging of sugar, cement, among others) and the craft sector: Madeira embroidery, tapestry and wicker items.
- The International Business Centre of Madeira, a free trade zone, has attracted foreign direct investment through a set of incentives, mainly tax-related.
- The late fifteenth-century cathedral is one of the few structures that survives virtually intact since the early period of the colonization of Madeira. The patron of the Gothic style cathedral is Our Lady of the Assumption. The roof of the cathedral features a Mudéjar-inspired design and is of cedar wood. The wooden choir stalls depict prophets, saints and apostles in 16th-century garb. In the decorative details of the seats and armrests, aspects of Madeira's life can also be seen, such as cherubs carrying a bunch of bananas or a wineskin. The cathedral contains a silver processional cross donated by King Manuel I of Portugal, considered one of the masterpieces of Manueline liturgical silverwork.
- The New Year fireworks in Madeira have been awarded the World Guiness Record for the Biggest Pyrotechnic Event of the World in 2006 and 2010.
- The highest points are Pico Ruivo (1 862 m), Pico das Torres (1 851 m) and Pico do Arieiro (1 818 m).
- All throughout the island are *levadas*, a network of water canals, built to bring water from the mountains down to the coastal areas, to irrigate the agricultural land. The network of *levadas* today has an impressive length of 3100 km of waterways, of which 80kms pass through tunnels and offer unique pedestrian pathways. 800 kms of these canals are being considered to qualify for inclusion in the World Heritage List.